



Food and Agriculture
Organization of the
United Nations



World Health
Organization



World Organisation
for Animal Health

Meeting of the One Health High-Level Expert Panel (OHHLEP)

15 & 16 June 2026

Note for the record

Day One-15 June 2026

11:00 – 11:20 : Opening Remarks

Amina Benyahia, Head of the One Health Initiative Unit at WHO, welcomed OHHLEP members and partners of the Quadripartite and noted that the June 15, 2026, OHHLEP full panel meeting marked a pivotal milestone as the panel convened for the first time following the official extension of its second term through April 2027. On behalf of the Quadripartite, she emphasized that this extension serves as a strategic bridge designed to finalize the key deliverables of the panel, including the Mapping of International Governance Instruments and the Enablers and Barriers (E&B) analysis which are slated for launch in Lisbon this September at the World One Health Congress (WOHC). Looking ahead, the Quadripartite is eager to move into the next phase of work, relying on the panel's expertise to identify blind spots and propose novel solutions to address systemic silos and guide future efforts.

Wanda Markotter, co-chair of OHHLEP, emphasized the need for a productive and forward-looking meeting focused on finalizing pending deliverables, specifically the E&B analysis and the governance mapping document. A critical goal is to prioritize future work ideas to shape the term extension period while aligning with Quadripartite work. The co-chair highlighted the excitement regarding the upcoming WOHC, the importance of transitioning to in-person engagement in Lisbon, and expressed gratitude for the panel's commitment in providing timely feedback on various Quadripartite projects.

Carlos Das Neves, co-chair of OHHLEP, echoed the need to move beyond theoretical discussions and prioritize operational, actionable outcomes. Acknowledging that previous meetings have set the necessary high-level stage, the focus is now squarely on "getting the business done" and providing the Quadripartite with practical, evidence-based recommendations. The co-chair emphasized the responsibility to help make One Health implementation work on the ground and requested the panel's focused feedback to identify how to best leverage their collective expertise for the next phase of the panel's work.

11:20 – 12:00: Session One: Updates from the Quadripartite

Cheng Liang Technical Officer One Health Initiative Unit at WHO, on behalf of the Quadripartite, provided OHHLEP members with a comprehensive update on the partners' ongoing work plan and strategic direction and activities.

1. Strategic Direction Following QEAM4 (Lyon, April 2026)

The Quadripartite emphasized that One Health has reached a transition point, moving from developing frameworks and securing political commitments to supporting practical implementation and measurable impact. This shift, highlighted during the Quadripartite Executive Annual Meeting 4 (QEAM4), necessitates focusing on high-impact priorities and

strengthening science-to-policy translation to better support countries and regions. Key decisions included extending the One Health Joint Plan of Action (OH JPA) to 2029, with a targeted review scheduled for 2027. Furthermore, WHO has assumed the Chair of the Quadripartite Secretariat, ensuring continued collaboration with OHHLEP as the primary scientific advisory mechanism while advancing the Quadripartite Joint Offer through coordinated resource mobilization. This also serves to enhance coordination, advocacy, and resource mobilization.

2. WHO Chairpersonship Priorities

WHO outlined five strategic priorities for its chairpersonship:

1. Strengthen the operational effectiveness of the Quadripartite.
2. Enhance advocacy and coordinated resource mobilization.
3. Support country-level implementation of the OH JPA.
4. Strengthen evidence-to-policy processes through OHHLEP and learning mechanisms.
5. Prepare for the next phase of the OH JPA through implementation reviews and documentation of lessons learned.

Beyond these priorities, the Quadripartite Secretariat is advancing an immediate workplan centered on finalizing the terms of reference for senior management and the secretariat. Operational activities currently include organizing the "Joint Offer" and investor roundtables, while simultaneously harmonizing OH JPA implementation methodologies across regions. This effort is complemented by planning for the future of the One Health Knowledge Nexus and Communities of Practice, alongside preparations for the OH JPA extension review process.

3. Progress on OH JPA Implementation

Regarding the implementation of the OH JPA, the Quadripartite is focused on developing a common methodology that balances standardization with the necessary flexibility for diverse country contexts. Recent efforts have focused on comparing implementation approaches developed through:

- The Malawi OH JPA pilot.
- The Asia-Pacific stocktaking exercise.
- A recent HQ-regional methodology exchange meeting was convened to identify common elements, lessons learned, and areas requiring flexibility.

4. Examples of Ongoing Joint Activities

The One Health Knowledge Nexus and its associated Communities of Practice continue to gain momentum, serving as vital platforms for connecting science, policy, and practice. The Governance Community of Practice has expanded to over 400 members across 80 countries, while the Return on Investment (ROI) Community of Practice engages more than 500 members in over 90 countries. These groups facilitate case studies, learning exchanges, and peer mentoring to strengthen national capacities.

The One Health Summit and Scientific Congress in Lyon reinforced the need to move from ambition to implementation, strengthen the science-policy interface, and increase investment in prevention, preparedness, and resilience, while maintaining a focus on country-level impact. OHHLEP was highlighted as a key scientific advisory mechanism supporting the Quadripartite.

5. Potential Areas for OHHLEP Contribution

The Secretariat identified several areas where OHHLEP can continue to contribute:

- Advising on OH JPA implementation methodologies.
- Supporting country implementation and capacity-building efforts where appropriate.
- Providing scientific advice to the Quadripartite and partner organizations.
- Contributing to advocacy and visibility efforts through major global One Health events and forums.

Chadia Wannous, One Health Global Coordinator at WOAHA, provided updates on several ongoing initiatives:

- Regional OH JPA workshops are being conducted in Central and West Africa, East and Southern Africa, and the Pacific region, with OHHLEP experts being invited to support these efforts.
- A renewed push for rabies elimination was launched to support achievement of the global “Zero by 30” target.
- A Joint FAO-WHO-WOAHA Learning Task Force has been established to harmonize learning approaches and improve access to training resources across organizations.
- WOAHA has launched a collaboration with the PREZODE initiative to strengthen the science-policy interface, including development of a practical handbook.
- Increased attention is being given to investment in animal health systems and veterinary services as a critical component of One Health implementation.
- WOAHA is developing a position paper on climate change and animal health and has launched a Wildlife Health Intelligence System to strengthen monitoring of wildlife health globally.

Discussion:

- The question of the Quadripartite’s engagement in preparations for the upcoming UN General Assembly High-Level Meeting on pandemic prevention, preparedness, and response was raised. It was noted that the Quadripartite is closely monitoring the process and exploring appropriate opportunities to ensure that One Health perspectives are reflected in related discussions and policy processes.
- The changing geopolitical and multilateral landscape was highlighted and a reflection encouraged on whether current One Health approaches remain fit for purpose in this evolving context.
- It was also noted that the upcoming UN General Assembly discussions present a potential opportunity to renew political attention to One Health and strengthen advocacy efforts.
- Members of OHHLEP emphasized the importance of maintaining a broad interpretation of “science” within One Health, ensuring that social, political, economic, and behavioral sciences are recognized alongside biomedical and quantitative disciplines.
- Participants highlighted continued challenges in communicating the full scope of One Health. Experiences shared from the Pacific region suggested that One Health is still frequently understood primarily through a zoonotic disease lens, indicating a need for further awareness-raising and capacity building.
- Members welcomed plans to document country implementation experiences and lessons learned since the launch of the OH JPA, noting that such stocktaking could help identify successful approaches as well as persistent enablers and barriers to implementation.
- Participants observed that despite broad acceptance of the OHHLEP definition of One Health, implementation and research efforts often continue to focus primarily on zoonotic diseases due to limitations in the available evidence base.

12:00 – 12:50: Session Two: One Health Enablers and Barriers (E&B)

Carlos Das Neves, OHHLEP co-chair and co-leader of the E&B deliverable, presented the progress on the E&B work that has resulted in 64 recommendations across multiple thematic areas. To improve usability and relevance for the Quadripartite, an exercise was undertaken to consolidate the recommendations into a smaller set of high-level implementation priorities. The recommendations were reviewed and analyzed against several criteria, including alignment with the OH JPA and its implementation framework, relevance across multiple JPA action tracks, potential impact, feasibility and implementation complexity, and applicability across local, national, regional, and global levels.

Following the analysis, the original 64 recommendations were consolidated into 10 overarching recommendations intended to provide clear and actionable guidance to the Quadripartite while retaining links to the more detailed recommendations contained as an annex to the full report.

The consolidated recommendations will be accompanied by short explanatory text, while detailed supporting recommendations and analysis will remain available in the report and annexes. The objective is to produce a concise and accessible set of recommendations that can be readily used by the Quadripartite and decision-makers.

Discussion:

- Participants welcomed the effort to synthesize and prioritize a large number of recommendations into a manageable set of high-level implementation priorities.
- Clarification was provided that the recommendations had been adjusted to focus specifically on actions that the Quadripartite can undertake to support OH JPA implementation.
- Members recommended that visual elements in the report reflect inclusive and gender-neutral representation. The drafting team agreed to review and revise the graphics accordingly.
- Members requested an opportunity to review the consolidated recommendations and accompanying explanatory text before finalization to ensure that they accurately reflect the collective views of OHHLEP.
- The consolidated recommendations were welcomed with caution against positioning community engagement, GEDSI, and local and Indigenous knowledge as an afterthought.
- It was emphasized that one of the major challenges in One Health implementation remains the disconnect between scientific and policy communities and the communities affected by One Health interventions.
- Participants noted that community engagement, inclusion, gender equality, and broader equity considerations should be treated as foundational and cross-cutting elements of implementation rather than standalone or lower-priority issues.
- Similar concerns were raised in the chat discussion, where participants noted that community engagement and GEDSI considerations had intentionally been embedded across multiple recommendation areas and should not be lost during consolidation.
- The need for One Health implementation approaches emerged as a critical point to better balance and optimize outcomes across human, animal, plant, and environmental health domains, consistent with the OHHLEP definition of One Health. It was suggested in this context to strengthen the integration of natural resource management and social equity considerations within economic and return-on-investment approaches.
- It was further highlighted methodological development as an important future role for OHHLEP, particularly in developing approaches that formally incorporate environmental and plant health considerations into implementation and evaluation frameworks.
- It was noted that the visual representation used to illustrate the recommendation consolidation process appeared overly linear.
- One Health implementation was suggested to be better represented as a cyclical or iterative process, with recurring engagement of communities, authorities, and practitioners throughout

implementation rather than at a single stage.

- Participants generally agreed that the proposed set of 10 recommendations captured the major themes emerging from the Enablers and Barriers analysis.
- Discussion highlighted the importance of reviewing the wording, order, and framing of the recommendations to ensure that key issues have not been omitted and that cross-cutting themes are adequately reflected.
- The Co-Chairs noted that the recommendation set would be circulated for further review, including opportunities to comment on the consolidated recommendations, supporting analysis, and visual summaries.

Action Points/Next Steps:

- Circulate the consolidated recommendation package, supporting analysis tables, and visual summaries to OHHLEP members for review.
- Provide OHHLEP members with an opportunity to review and comment on the proposed set of 10 consolidated recommendations and accompanying explanatory text.
- Refine recommendation wording/framing and ordering based on members' feedback.
- Ensure that community engagement, GEDSI, local and Indigenous knowledge, and broader equity considerations remain visible as cross-cutting implementation priorities.
- Consider how environmental integration, natural resource management, and social equity can be more explicitly reflected within implementation and investment-related recommendations.
- Finalize Section 4 of the Enablers and Barriers report, including the consolidated recommendations and accompanying summary text, in preparation for submission and presentation at the World One Health Congress (WOHC) in Lisbon.

12:50 – 13:00: Break

13:00 – 13:45: Session Three: Mapping of One Health Instruments

Gian Luca Burci, OHHLEP member and lead of the deliverable, provided an update on the progress of the governance mapping deliverable, noting that the initial vision was refined to address complexity. Key updates and refinements include:

- The document is focused on international normative instruments, encompassing both binding treaties and non-binding "soft law" (codes, standards, frameworks)
- It is organized with numbering and sections, incorporating boxes for key messages to improve readability with a practical view by including key policy messages and takeaways
- specifies that a number of tools have been developed to manage interactions and possible conflicts among treaties
- It includes a figure displaying the interlinkages between the identified instruments; and
- expands on the systemic dimensions supporting and/or constraining One Health governance
- The document also clarifies the role of the environment as an overarching component rather than one sector in a list of sectors representing the ecosystem where solutions must be implemented.
- Four new instruments were included: the UN Convention on the Law of the Sea, the 1992 Rio Declaration, and two FAO codes (Pesticide Management and Sustainable Management of Plastics in Agriculture).
- A hypothetical scenario focused on Antimicrobial Resistance (AMR) was added, to provide a practical example for the Quadripartite.

Reflecting further on the methodology, Gian Luca Burci acknowledged the academic nature of the document, noted inherent subjective "judgment calls" in fitting sectoral instruments into a multidisciplinary frame, and highlighted the need for more user-friendly platforms (e.g., Monday.com) in future iterations.

Discussion:

- Participants acknowledged the usefulness of the document and its alignment with the recommendation resulting from the One Health Lyon meeting on better integration of One Health in legal frameworks.
- It was suggested to review the note to better integrate human rights, gender, and inclusion, noting the risk of perpetuating "gender-blind" frameworks. This could be reflected in the background section, as a thematic box or in the existing figures. A similar recommendation was made regarding data and knowledge sharing.
- Participants also noted that the paper should provide further details on the methodological limitations, the criteria used for selecting instruments, and the rationale for excluding certain One Health domains.
- It was confirmed that the deliverable has undergone rigorous review by the legal departments of the Quadripartite organizations in the past year.
- It was suggested to expand the discussion of gaps and future actions for One Health, however this should be conducted by specifying how they can be addressed through existing mechanisms.
- Reordering the document to prioritize the "Audience" section.

Action Points and Next Steps:

- The deadline for comments proposed is the 30th of June. The finalization and clearance process will commence after that.
- Development of a 2-3 page, action-oriented policy brief is considered.
- Gian Luca will lead the conversion of the work into an academic article focusing on the international law/relations perspective.

13:45 – 14:00: Closing of Day One

Day Two-16 June 2026

11:00 – 11:15: Opening of Day Two

The Co-Chairs of OHHLEP Wanda Markotter and Carlos Das Neves, welcomed participants to the second day of OHHLEP's third meeting of Term II, and informed participants of amendments made to the agenda in terms of the order of session for the second day.

11:15 – 12:15 : Panel Session One: Shaping the Strategic Opinion Piece of OHHLEP

Hugo Mantilla Meluk and David Hayman (OHHLEP members), presented the proposed scope and structure for a planned opinion piece addressing recent Ebola and hantavirus outbreaks. To illustrate their points, they provided an overview of the 2026 Andes hantavirus outbreak linked to cruise ship travel, highlighting the utility of geospatial analysis to track rodent reservoir species and examine environmental contributors to transmission, such as habitat degradation and seasonality. The presenters emphasized that this recent outbreak underscores the critical need for continuous environmental surveillance, given how directly climate variables influence spillover risks. Consequently, their upcoming article will provide background on both diseases, introduce a general framework for spillover risk reduction, and elaborate on a One Health prevention approach that positions robust surveillance as the backbone of future prevention and policy implications.

Discussion:

- The opinion piece will focus on Ebola and hantavirus due to recent attention received, however meeting participants suggested to specify how the topics covered in the paper are relevant for other health threats, including Nipah virus, leptospirosis and New World screwworm.
- The paper was suggested to provide a comparison of the two diseases, highlighting differences in current understanding of socio-ecological transmission dynamics, the predictability of outbreaks in relation to climate variability, and levels of community engagement.
- The paper could also compare bats and rodents as reservoir species. The hantavirus and Ebola outbreaks serve as key exemplars, illustrating respectively the importance of intergovernmental collaboration and the centrality of community and social dynamics.
- Participants emphasized that the paper should move beyond describing the outbreaks to underline the importance of a One Health preventive approach. Discussion centred on upstream strategies to mitigate zoonotic spillover, including understanding disease dynamics in natural reservoirs, drivers of disease emergence, and integrated surveillance.
- Other topics raised included the impact of urbanization, the political economy of diseases, human rights and livelihoods, and linkages to the Pandemic Agreement and the One Health Joint Plan of Action. Participants encouraged a strong environmental perspective and a call for further research into primary drivers.
- A key discussion point was the importance of integrating environmental, animal, and human health surveillance systems to improve early detection, reduce exposure, and lower long-term costs. The group addressed governance challenges, including the need for cross-sector agreements, harmonization, clearer global oversight, and resourcing. The discussion also highlighted political

barriers to integration, the high return on investment, and the potential for using indicators, such as those within the Global One Health Index, to track national implementation.

- Given the breadth of topics, it was noted that the paper needs to be strategic and prioritize specific dimensions rather than attempting to cover everything, with a primary goal of raising awareness.

Action Points and Next Steps:

- The group leading the deliverable will develop a draft by the end of June or beginning of July to share with OHHLEP members.

12:15 – 12:30: Break

12:30 – 13:30: Panel Session Two: Additional Deliverables for OHHLEP Term II Extension - OHHLEP Results

Amira Preure, Consultant at the One Health Initiative Unit at WHO and member of the OHHLEP Secretariat, presented the results of the survey circulated with OHHLEP members and aimed at gathering input from panel members on priority thematic areas and deliverables for the term extension (ending April 2027). The results highlight a strategic shift toward focused, high-impact outputs and better global alignment.

Key Survey Findings:

- **Key Priority Areas:** The most echoed thematic areas included:
 - Governance (8 mentions).
 - Gender equity and community engagement (7 mentions).
 - Prevention (linking to drivers) and Environment (7 mentions).
 - Economics and finance (5 mentions).
- **Preferred Deliverables:** The panel expressed a clear preference for actionable formats. Technical reports, guidelines, and guidance documents were the most selected (15 mentions), followed by policy briefs (11 mentions) and opinion pieces (10 mentions). Additionally, panel members emphasized that all future deliverables should be selective, focused, short, implementation-oriented, and structured through working groups.
- **Time-Sensitive Opportunities:** Strategic advocacy should align with major global events. The World One Health Congress (WOHC) was cited as the most timely opportunity, followed by Quadripartite-organized events such as the World Health Assembly and the WOAHA General Session. Other key forums mentioned for potential advocacy include the G20, G7, World Health Summit, and COP meetings.
- **Timeline:** The planning phase is currently underway, with deliverables expected to be finalized by July 2026 and completed by April 2027.

Discussion:

- Concerns were raised regarding the feasibility of producing "technical reports and guidelines" within the 10-month timeframe due to the required extensive consultation processes. Policy briefs and opinion pieces were proposed instead as more achievable options.
- The need for counterfactual economic analysis was highlighted for integrated surveillance systems to demonstrate return on investment, which other panel members expressed interest in joining or supporting.

- A recurring theme was the difficulty of integrating environmental perspectives into One Health policy. Participants discussed the need for better "perfusion" between environmental, animal, and public health policies. A methodology to formally include the environment in One Health assessments was proposed as a potential deliverable.
- The Quadripartite representatives received and acknowledged OHHLEP members inputs while consolidating their own ideas and reviewing OHHLEP suggestions to ensure alignment. They noted that the Joint Plan of Action (JPA) has been extended to 2029, with a targeted review planned for 2027.

Action Points and Next Steps:

- The Quadripartite will consolidate their needs and share them with the Bureau/Secretariat.
- A Bureau meeting is scheduled to finalize the selection of two or three feasible deliverables for the current term.

13:30 – 13:45: Conclusion and AOB

- **World One Health Congress in Lisbon:**

The preparations for the OHHLEP session at the World One Health Congress are underway.

- **Documentation:**

Members are requested to review the consolidated 64 recommendations (Excel) and the forthcoming Chapter 4 (introduction and 10 high-level recommendations). Section chairs are to coordinate two case studies (500–750 words) for inclusion in Chapter 3 of the Enablers and Barriers report.

Closing of Remarks

Carlos Das Neves, co-chair of OHHLEP, thanked panel members for their engagement and emphasized the role of the Secretariat of OHHLEP in supporting the panel's work. Carlos Das Neves expressed appreciation for the return to full panel meetings and concluded by handing over the floor to Junxia Song for the closing remarks.

Junxia Song, FAO Deputy Chief Veterinarian, Chief of One Health and Disease Control Branch at FAO HQ, thanked the participants for their active engagement and valuable contributions, noting that the productive discussions highlighted both the progress of OHHLEP and the ongoing challenges in implementing the One Health agenda. She stressed the importance of speaking with one voice, bridging the gap between science and policy, and continuing to collaborate to make One Health operational and impactful, while also looking forward to further engagement in future meetings like the one in Lisbon.

End of Meeting

List of participants

OHHLEP members

Salama Al Muhairi; Salome Bukachi; Gian Luca Burci; Natalia Cediél; Dominique Charron; Osman Dar; Nitish Debnath; Chris Degeling; Jing Fang; Elmoubasher Farag; Carlos Das Neves; David Hayman; Ekhlās Hailat; Catherine Machalaba; Hugo Mantilla Meluk; Wanda Markotter; Serge Morand; Natela Oliveira; Abel Wilson Walekewa; Xiao-Nong Zhou; Jakob Zinsstag; Maxine Whittaker; Rungtip Chuanchuen; Hung Nguyen-Viet.

FAO

Junxia Song; Barbara Haesler; Fairouz Larfaoui.

UNEP

Anjana Varma; Nadja Münstermann.

WOAH

Chadia Wannous; Mauro De Rosa.

WHO

Amina Benyahia; Amira Preure; Taraneh Shojae; Cheng Liang; Scott Chiossi; Isha Tendolkar; Helene De Mulder; Aubrey Musngi-Anouar.

Guests:

Siona Sharma.

Apologies:

Thomas Mettenleiter; Annamaria Conte; Ryan Blake Williams; Casey Barton Behraves; Yewande Alimi; Julian Blanc (UNEP).